

Calendar Line 5

Case Name: *Christopher Cheung vs Rivian, LLC*

Case No.: 25CV460138

"The party seeking arbitration bears the burden of proving the existence of an arbitration agreement, and the party opposing arbitration bears the burden of proving any defense[.]" (*Pinnacle Museum Tower Assn. v. Pinnacle Market Development (US), LLC* (2012) 55 Cal.4th 223, 236.)

Plaintiff contends the Purchase Agreement attached to Defendant's motion is inadmissible and that Defendant has not established that he agreed to it. These arguments are unpersuasive. Defendant has met its initial burden by attaching a copy of the arbitration agreement purporting to bear Plaintiff's signature. (See *Gamboa v. Northeast Community Clinic* (2021) 72 Cal.App.5th 158, 165.) Although Defendant need not follow the normal procedures of document authentication (*Condee v. Longwood Management Corp.* (2001) 88 Cal.App.4th 215, 219), the Court believes Defendant's evidence is more than sufficient to establish authentication.¹ In response Plaintiff does not provide a declaration or any other evidence to suggest he did not enter into the Purchase Agreement. Indeed, as Defendant points out, Plaintiff would be hard pressed to do so when he is bringing suit as the purchaser of the vehicle.

Plaintiff's additional arguments also lack merit. Defendant is not attempting to enforce an arbitration agreement contained within a warranty agreement. The Arbitration Agreement here is contained in the Purchase Agreement that Plaintiff entered into when he purchased the vehicle. In addition, none of Plaintiff's claims arises under the Magnuson-Moss Warranty Act ("MMWA"). Accordingly, Plaintiff's reliance on the MMWA is misplaced. So too is Plaintiff's argument that the Federal Arbitration Act "simply does not apply in state court." (Opposition, at p. 7.) "[T]he parties may ... voluntarily elect to have the FAA govern enforcement of the Agreement, as they did here." (*Victrola 89, LLC v. Jaman Properties 8 LLC* (2020) 46 Cal.App.5th 337, 355.)

Lastly, Plaintiff's resort to Code of Civil Procedure § 1281.2 is of no avail. Rather than joining in Defendant's motion or conceding, Plaintiff's opposition, and indeed his filing of the instant action, clearly shows his refusal to arbitrate.

The motion is GRANTED and the case is STAYED under Code of Civil Procedure section 1281.4. The court VACATES the case management conference that is currently scheduled for November 13, 2025 and instead sets this matter for a case status review regarding arbitration on **April 24, 2026 at 10:00 a.m.** in Department 13.

Defendant to prepare the final order within 10 days of the date of the hearing.

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¹ Plaintiff's evidentiary objections are overruled.

Calendar Line 7

Case Name: *David Green v. Yelena Green et al.*

Case No.: 25CV466337

I. BACKGROUND

On May 22, 2025, plaintiff David M. Green (“Plaintiff”) filed a judicial form complaint (“Form Complaint”) against defendants Yelena Green (“Yelena”) and Dmitry Green (“Dmitry”) (collectively, “Defendants”).²

The Form Complaint contains the following, limited information: 1) it is an unlimited civil case; 2) the action is subject to Civil Code section 1812.10; 3) the subject incident took place in Saratoga, CA; 4) Plaintiff is seeking injunctive or equitable relief; and 5) Plaintiff alleges that Defendants took property and have yet to return it. There are no additional allegations or exhibits attached to the Form Complaint.

On June 17, 2025, Yelena, appearing in pro per,³ filed a motion labeled as a Motion to Dismiss directed at the Form Complaint. Yelena is now represented by counsel and apparently intends to go forward with the motion filed by Yelena. On October 8, 2025, Plaintiff filed a response to the motion.

II. PROCEDURAL ISSUES ON MOTION TO DISMISS

As an initial matter, the Court addresses the process of moving to dismiss an action. “The procedure of moving to dismiss an action based on extrinsic evidence is disapproved in California and the motion is permitted only where it complies with the requirements for a motion for summary judgment.” (*Saltarelli & Steponovich v. Douglas* (1995) 40 Cal.App.4th 1, 5.) Here, Yelena’s motion does not comply with any of the procedural requirements for a motion for summary judgment. With that said, “the motion may be treated as a nonstatutory motion for judgment on the pleadings. Such a motion may be granted when the complaint fails to state facts sufficient to constitute a cause of action.” (*Id.* at p. 5.) Furthermore, the Court is authorized by statute to grant judgment on the pleadings on its own motion. (See Code Civ. Proc., § 438, subd. (b)(2).)

Accordingly, the Court must treat Yelena’s motion to dismiss as a motion for judgment on the pleadings. Further, as courts do not consider extrinsic evidence on pleading motions, it must, if anything, instead treat Yelena’s proffered evidence as a request for judicial notice.

² The court refers to the parties, who share the same last name, by their first names for purposes of clarity. No disrespect is intended. (See *Rubenstein v. Rubenstein* (2000) 81 Cal.App.4th 1131, 1136, fn. 1.)

³ “[W]hen a litigant is appearing in propria persona, he is entitled to the same, but no greater, consideration than other litigants and attorneys. Further, the in propria persona litigant is held to the same restrictive rules of procedure as an attorney.” (*Burnete v. La Casa Dana Apartments* (2007) 148 Cal.App.4th 1262, 1267 [internal citations omitted].)